that an amplified and developed version could make everything about life fall into place, in the heart as well as in the brain. I would write a book extolling the gene's eye view of evolution. It should concentrate its examples on social behaviour, to help correct the unconscious group selectionism that then pervaded popular Darwinism. I began the book in 1972 when powers-cuts resulting from industrial strife interrupted my laboratory research. The blackouts unfortunately (from one point of view) ended after a mere two chapters, and I shelved the project until I had a sabbatical leave in 1975. Meanwhile the theory had been extended, notably by John Maynard Smith and Robert Trivers. I now see that it was one of those mysterious periods in which new ideas are hovering in the air. I wrote *The Selfish Gene* in something resembling a fever of excitement.

When Oxford University Press approached me for a second edition they insisted that a conventional, comprehensive, page by page revision was inappropriate. There are some books that, from their conception, are obviously destined for a string of editions, and *The Selfish Gene* was not one of them. The first edition borrowed a youthful quality from the times in which it was written. There was a whiff of revolution abroad, a streak of Wordsworth's blissful dawn. A pity to change a child of those times, fatten it with new facts or wrinkle it with complications and cautions. So, the original text should stand, warts, sexist pronouns and all. Notes at the end would cover corrections, responses and developments. And there should be entirely new chapters, on subjects whose novelty in their own time would carry forward the mood of revolutionary dawn. The result was Chapters 12 and 13. For these I took my inspiration from the two books in the field that have most excited me during the intervening years: Robert Axelrod's *The Evolution of Cooperation*, because it seems to offer some sort of hope for our future; and my own *The Extended Phenotype* because for me it dominated those years and because—for what that is worth—it is probably the finest thing I shall ever write.

The title 'Nice guys finish first' is borrowed from the BBC *Horizon* television programme that I presented in 1985. This was a fifty-minute documentary on game-theoretic approaches to the evolution of cooperation, produced by Jeremy Taylor. The making of this film, and another, *The Blind Watchmaker*, by the same producer, gave me a new respect for his profession. At their best, *Horizon* producers (some of their programmes can be seen in America, often repackaged under the name